



Acer's new chromebook

Acer's new \$199 15.6-inch Chromebook claims to offer 12-hour battery life
<http://dgit.in/AcerCBk>



Bendable display

A smartphone featuring bendable display could be launched by Xiaomi soon
<http://dgit.in/XiaoBndD>

Dual Camera Phones



PARAMETER #3: IMAGE NOISE AND SHARPNESS

Apple iPhone 7 Plus

One of the reasons why the iPhone is hailed for its camera is because of Apple's famed noise reduction algorithm, and the iPhone 7 Plus is great at it. Image noise is kept well under control. Under bright daylight, you will not find any hint of incidental image noise, which is awesome. At dawn, dusk or any tricky lighting conditions, the iPhone 7 Plus does well to suppress noise or render fine pixel noise that can contribute to artistic post-processing of photos.



In low light, however, the results are not always constant. While the iPhone 7 Plus tends to produce fine, controlled image noise as long as there is at least an obscure light source, in darker situations it produces coarse, non-uniform image noise. This is possibly the only weak point for the iPhone 7 Plus' camera, although you will need to be shooting at really dark conditions to bring out the worst of the iPhone.

Image sharpness, though, remains uniform. While the iPhone 7 Plus produces very sharp photographs in well-lit and even partially-lit frames, low light photos also retain sharpness of subjects, albeit the noise. This is what works for the iPhone, in making it one of the best smartphone cameras.

Huawei P9

No matter how much we blame the Huawei P9 for producing oversaturated, high contrast colours more often than not, one aspect that the Huawei P9 aces is in sharpness and details of subjects. The primary purpose of the dual-camera mechanism is to produce greater levels of details in photographs, and the Huawei P9 excels in this department.

Most photographs shot bright light and partial light produce impressive sharpness levels, but in low light, the



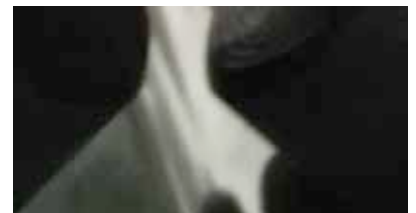
noise reduction algorithm makes subject outlines softer.

Image noise, meanwhile, has a similar story as sharpness. While daylight and other photographs with good light sources exhibit little to bare minimum image noise, low light photographs render a considerable amount of image noise which is undesirable.

The rendered noise does not look as fine as the noise produced by the iPhone, but is still more consistent than the iPhone 7 Plus' low light performance. It is not the best noise cancellation algorithm ever made, but all factors considered make the Huawei P9 one of the best Android smartphone cameras around. Definitely worth considering, no doubt.

Honor 8

The Honor 8 produces more noise in photographs than the Huawei P9 and Apple iPhone 7 Plus. While daylight photos are devoid of image noise, low light photos have plenty of noise. In fact, photographs shot with a dim source of light also produce significant image noise, something that the Apple iPhone 7 Plus and Huawei P9 don't suffer from. The other two smartphones also produce finer image noise, although that is evident only on close scrutiny.



In terms of details, the Honor 8 shoots a fairly decent amount of details in photographs. The dual-camera setup borrows a lot from the Huawei P9, although objects do appear sharper on the Huawei P9. That said, photographs are sharp enough for practical usage here, too, and along with the softer backgrounds, photographs look quite good. Notably, the iPhone 7 Plus produces a good balance of soft backgrounds, sharp foreground, limited noise and close-to-source colours. The Huawei P9 follows in second place, but the Honor 8 is not too far behind. It is also the most affordable of the lot, which deserves a special mention in this price-sensitive smartphone market of India.